

Prediction Target Specification Module

Module: PTSM — Prediction Target Specification Module

Parent Standard: POPS — Prediction Object & Purpose Standard

Architecture: PGA™ — Prediction Governance Architecture

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Prediction Governance

Governed Space: Prediction Target Specification

Primary Governed Object: Prediction Target

Module Type: Core Module

Canonical Language: UCL — Universal Canonical Language

Protection: MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

1. Canonical Definition

The Prediction Target Specification Module (PTSM) governs the specification, differentiation, coherence, and continuity of the particular future or unresolved outcome, state, condition, event, value, behavior, development, or transition toward which a prediction is directed.

PTSM transforms an identified Prediction Object and defined Predictive Purpose into a sufficiently specified Prediction Target capable of supporting subsequent horizon, boundary, methodology, probability, feasibility, outcome association, and performance governance.

A Prediction Object establishes what is under predictive governance.

A Prediction Target establishes what about that object is predicted .

2. Operational Role

PTSM is the third operational module within POPS.

It receives:

Identified Prediction Object + Defined Predictive Purpose

and establishes the specific Prediction Target to which subsequent predictive treatment applies.

Its principal transition is:

Prediction Object + Predictive Purpose → Specified Prediction Target

PTSM prevents broad subjects, ambiguous expected outcomes, alternative targets, or retrospectively modified outcome definitions from being treated as though they represented the same predictive proposition.

3. Internal Module Flow

Prediction Object Identification → Predictive Purpose Definition → → Prediction Target Specification →
Prediction Horizon Definition → Predictive Boundary Establishment



Current Position: Prediction Target Specification

PTSM receives governed outputs from POIM and PPDM and produces the specified Prediction Target required by PHDM — Prediction Horizon Definition Module .

4. Operational Space

PTSM operates within the Prediction Target Specification space.

It governs:

target identification; target specification; target type; target state; target measurability where applicable; target differentiation; target granularity; target ambiguity; target multiplicity; target coherence; target continuity; target change.

PTSM does not determine whether the target will occur.

It establishes what outcome or condition the prediction is actually directed toward.

5. Operational Scope

A Prediction Target may concern:

occurrence or non-occurrence of an event; future state; future condition; quantitative value; value range; direction of change; behavioral outcome; system state; threshold crossing; categorical outcome; sequence or transition; development; unresolved outcome; another sufficiently specifiable predictive result.

PTSM remains neutral regarding the domain and the mechanism used to produce the prediction.

6. Prediction Target Identification

PTSM must identify the specific predictive target associated with the Prediction Object.

The target must answer:

What particular outcome, state, condition, event, value, behavior, development, or transition concerning the Prediction Object is intended to be predicted?

The target must remain distinguishable from the broader object.

Prediction Object $\neq$ Prediction Target

7. Target Specification

A target must be specified with sufficient precision to support subsequent predictive governance.

Specification must establish enough meaning for later PGA™ governance to determine what probability, uncertainty, feasibility, monitoring, outcome association, and performance refer to.

Target specification must not introduce artificial precision unsupported by the predictive proposition.

Target Specificity $\neq$ Artificial Precision

8. Target Type

PTSM must preserve the nature of the Prediction Target where that nature materially affects predictive meaning.

A target may represent, for example:

Event Occurrence

State

Condition

Value

Range

Direction

Threshold

Category

Behavior

Transition

Different target types may require materially different downstream predictive treatment.

PTSM identifies the target type without determining the methodology appropriate to it.

9. Target State

Where applicable, the Prediction Target must establish the state whose realization would correspond to the predictive proposition.

The target state must be sufficiently distinguishable from materially different states.

An unresolved or ambiguous target state can prevent legitimate later determination of whether the predicted outcome corresponds with governed Operational Reality.

Target State $\neq$ Actual Outcome

PTSM specifies the target.

It does not determine whether the target was realized.

10. Target Measurability

Where a Prediction Target concerns a measurable value, quantity, range, threshold, or condition, the target must be sufficiently capable of later evaluation.

Target measurability does not require all predictions to be purely quantitative.

Qualitative or categorical targets may remain legitimate where their outcome conditions can be sufficiently established.

Quantification $\neq$ Target Validity

The requirement is evaluability, not unnecessary numerical representation.

11. Target Granularity

The target must have sufficient granularity for the Predictive Purpose.

A target that is excessively broad may prevent meaningful probability, feasibility, monitoring, or performance assessment.

A target that is artificially narrow may imply predictive precision not supported by later methodology or Prediction Basis.

PTSM therefore governs sufficient target granularity rather than maximal specificity.

12. Target Ambiguity

PTSM must identify ambiguity capable of producing materially different interpretations of the predicted target.

Ambiguity may arise from:

undefined target terminology; multiple possible outcome meanings; unclear quantitative units; unresolved categories; unclear threshold conditions; conflation of different target states; ambiguous occurrence

conditions; unclear direction of change.

A target must not be treated as sufficiently specified where materially different outcomes could all retrospectively be represented as satisfying the same prediction.

13. Target Differentiation

PTSM must distinguish the intended Prediction Target from related but materially different targets.

For the same Prediction Object, predictions may concern different:

values; states; events; thresholds; directions; behaviors; developments; conditions.

Those targets must remain independently identifiable.

Same Prediction Object $\neq$ Same Prediction Target

14. Multiple Prediction Targets

A Prediction Object may support more than one Prediction Target.

PTSM must determine whether multiple targets constitute:

a legitimate compound Prediction Target; related but separately governed targets; conditional targets; alternative targets; materially independent predictive propositions.

Multiple targets must not be collapsed into a single target where doing so obscures materially different predictive outcomes.

Multiple Targets $\neq$ Automatically One Prediction

15. Compound Prediction Targets

A compound target may be legitimate where multiple target components collectively form the predictive proposition.

Where success of the prediction depends upon several conditions being jointly satisfied, those conditions must remain identifiable.

The architecture must not permit partial satisfaction of a compound target to be retrospectively represented as full satisfaction unless the original predictive proposition explicitly allowed it.

Partial Target Satisfaction $\neq$ Complete Target Realization

16. Conditional Prediction Targets

A target may apply only under specified conditions.

PTSM may identify the conditional nature of the target but does not govern the complete predictive assumptions or conditional probability associated with it.

Those functions belong to later PGA™ standards.

Conditional Target $\neq$ Unconditional Prediction

17. Target–Purpose Alignment

The Prediction Target must remain compatible with the defined Predictive Purpose.

PTSM must identify material mismatch where the target does not answer the predictive question implied by the purpose.

A purpose concerning operational capacity, for example, must not silently rely upon a target measuring a materially different phenomenon unless that relationship is explicitly governed elsewhere.

Target Availability $\neq$ Target Fitness for Purpose

18. Target–Horizon Relationship

A Prediction Target may materially change in meaning depending on the horizon over which it applies.

PTSM establishes the target itself.

PHDM — Prediction Horizon Definition Module establishes the applicable temporal frame.

The target must be sufficiently specified for that horizon to be attached without redefining what is being predicted.

Prediction Target $\neq$ Prediction Horizon

19. Target–Boundary Relationship

The Prediction Target identifies the specific predicted outcome or condition.

The Predictive Boundary determines the limits within which that target is governed.

PTSM must establish sufficient target clarity for PBEM — Predictive Boundary Establishment Module to determine what remains inside and outside the predictive proposition.

Target Specification $\neq$ Predictive Boundary Establishment

20. Target Continuity

The Prediction Target must remain sufficiently identifiable throughout the Prediction Lifecycle.

Later changes in methodology, Prediction Basis, assumptions, probability, uncertainty, or forecast value must not silently redefine the original target.

Where the target itself materially changes, that change must remain distinguishable.

Changed Prediction Value $\neq$ Changed Prediction Target

Changed Prediction Target $\neq$ Unchanged Predictive Proposition

21. Retrospective Target Drift

PTSM must protect against retrospective reinterpretation of the target after new information or the actual outcome becomes available.

A prediction must not appear more successful merely because the original target is later broadened, narrowed, reclassified, or reinterpreted.

This is essential for later outcome and performance governance.

Outcome Knowledge $\neq$ Permission to Redefine the Original Target

The original governed target must remain historically identifiable.

22. Target Specification Sufficiency

A Prediction Target is sufficiently specified when it:

identifies the particular predicted outcome or condition; remains distinguishable from the Prediction Object; has sufficient specificity for its Predictive Purpose; has an identifiable target type where relevant; supports subsequent horizon and boundary governance; is sufficiently evaluable against a later governed outcome; distinguishes materially different alternative targets; preserves compound or conditional structure where applicable; can remain identifiable throughout the Prediction Lifecycle.

Target specification does not establish target feasibility, probability, or correctness.

23. Governance Requirements

PTSM requires that:

1. the Prediction Target be explicitly identifiable; 2. the target remain associated with the correct Prediction Object; 3. the target remain compatible with the defined Predictive Purpose; 4. the target be sufficiently specific without artificial precision; 5. target type be identifiable where materially relevant; 6. material target ambiguity be resolved; 7. materially different targets remain distinguishable; 8. compound and conditional targets remain structurally identifiable where applicable; 9. the target support subsequent horizon and boundary establishment; 10. material target changes remain historically distinguishable; 11. the target remain capable of later association with an applicable governed outcome.

24. Governance Logic

PTSM applies the following operational logic:

Identified Prediction Object

Defined Predictive Purpose

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Candidate Prediction Target

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Target Identification

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Target Type Determination

↓

Target Specification

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Granularity / Ambiguity Assessment

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Multiple / Compound / Conditional Target Assessment where applicable

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Target–Purpose Alignment

↓

Target Specification Sufficiency

↓

Specified Prediction Target

↓

PHDM — Prediction Horizon Definition Module

Where target sufficiency is not established:

Target Gap → Clarification / Differentiation → Reassessment

25. Minimum Implementation Framework

A minimum implementation of PTSM must establish:

A. Prediction Object Reference

The identified Prediction Object to which the target belongs.

B. Predictive Purpose Reference

The defined Predictive Purpose the target is intended to support.

C. Prediction Target Statement

A precise statement of the specific predicted outcome, state, condition, event, value, behavior, development, or transition.

D. Target Type

The applicable target form where materially relevant.

E. Target Specification

The characteristics necessary to distinguish the target from materially different outcomes.

F. Target Granularity

Confirmation that target specificity is sufficient without unsupported precision.

G. Target Ambiguity Status

Identification of unresolved interpretations capable of materially changing target meaning.

H. Target Structure

Where applicable:

Single / Multiple / Compound / Conditional / Alternative

I. Target Evaluability

Confirmation that the target is capable of later association with an applicable governed outcome.

J. Target State

At minimum:

Unspecified → Candidate → Clarification Required → Specified → Changed

Only a sufficiently Specified target may proceed as the established target into subsequent POPS governance.

26. Governance Outputs

PTSM may produce:

Specified Prediction Target; target type; target statement; target granularity state; target ambiguity state; target structure; target evaluability state; target-purpose alignment state; target specification state; unresolved target requirements.

The primary governed output is:

Specified Prediction Target

This proceeds with the Prediction Object and Predictive Purpose into:

PHDM — Prediction Horizon Definition Module

27. Critical Distinctions

Prediction Object ≠ Prediction Target

Predictive Purpose ≠ Prediction Target

Prediction Target ≠ Predicted Value Alone

Prediction Target ≠ Prediction Horizon

Prediction Target ≠ Predictive Boundary

Target State $\neq$ Actual Outcome

Target Specificity $\neq$ Artificial Precision

Quantification $\neq$ Target Validity

Same Prediction Object $\neq$ Same Prediction Target

Multiple Targets $\neq$ Automatically One Prediction

Partial Target Satisfaction $\neq$ Complete Target Realization

Conditional Target $\neq$ Unconditional Prediction

Target Availability $\neq$ Target Fitness for Purpose

Changed Prediction Value $\neq$ Changed Prediction Target

Outcome Knowledge $\neq$ Permission to Redefine the Original Target

28. Enterprise Application

PTSM provides a stable target-definition layer across human forecasting, analytical systems, AI models, autonomous agents, prediction markets, enterprise forecasting, risk systems, and machine-readable predictive environments.

This allows different predictions concerning the same object to remain distinguishable by the outcomes they actually claim.

It also provides the target reference required for later probability representation, feasibility assessment, monitoring, outcome association, predictive calibration, and performance evaluation.

29. Use Case 1 — Weather Prediction

A weather system identifies a defined geographic weather condition as its Prediction Object and establishes operational warning as its Predictive Purpose.

“Rain” alone may remain insufficient as a Prediction Target.

PTSM establishes the specific target condition, such as measurable precipitation exceeding a defined threshold.

This prevents materially different outcomes—light precipitation, severe rainfall, regional rainfall, or no threshold exceedance—from later being treated as though they represented the same original target.

The Prediction Horizon and complete geographic or operational boundary remain governed by subsequent POPS modules.

30. Use Case 2 — Digital Asset Price Prediction

A predictive system concerns the future price of a specified digital asset.

PTSM distinguishes between materially different targets such as:

price exceeds a threshold

price reaches a threshold

price closes above a threshold

price remains above a threshold

price increases by a defined percentage

These statements may concern the same Prediction Object while representing different Prediction Targets.

PTSM establishes which target is actually being predicted before horizon, methodology, probability, feasibility, or eventual predictive performance are governed.

31. Canonical Boundary

PTSM governs the specification, differentiation, granularity, structure, evaluability, coherence, change, and continuity of the Prediction Target associated with an identified Prediction Object and defined Predictive Purpose. It does not govern Prediction Horizon, Predictive Boundary establishment, predictive methodology, Prediction Basis, assumptions, probability, uncertainty, feasibility, communication, reliance, revision, Operational Reality determination, predictive performance, or Prediction Record continuity.

PTSM establishes what specific outcome or condition is being predicted about the Prediction Object .

Canonical Closing Statement

A prediction cannot be meaningfully evaluated against an outcome that was never clearly specified as its target.

PTSM establishes the Prediction Target before probability, feasibility, performance, or eventual outcome knowledge can alter how the original prediction is understood.

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